

Bibliography

The following is a list of publications known to me that discuss our UFO sighting. It is probably not complete. Only items 4, 10, 12 and 13 were based on interviews with me. Almost all of this material contains major errors of fact.

1. *Flying Saucers -- Top Secret*, by Major Donald Keyhoe, 1960, Chapter 1, pages 9-26. Admiral Fahrney demands congressional hearings, page 26, Keyhoe is interviewed on CBS TV, begins to say he has an important announcement, and CBS turns off his microphone! The entire Chapter 1 is attached as an appendix.
2. *Confidential NICAP Report To Congress*, by Major Donald Keyhoe, June 21, 1960, page 56.
3. *Aliens From Space*, 1973, by Major Donald Keyhoe, Chapter 6, pages 92-105. Keyhoe says NICAP intended to use our "startling case" and crew testimony for congressional hearings. Page 103, Admiral Hillenkoetter's letter to Congress. The entire Chapter 6 is attached as an appendix.
4. NICAP Newsletters for September and October 1970. These newsletters are attached as an appendix.
5. June 1973 issue of *Naval Aviation News*, pages 18-19, article titled "Unidentified Flying Object," a special issue that included a discussion of the famous "lost patrol" Flight 19 lost in the "Bermuda Triangle." This article is attached as an appendix.
6. *UFOs Explained*, by Philip Klass, 1974, pages 61 through 73.
7. Time-Life book series "Mysteries of the Unknown," volume titled *The UFO Phenomenon*, 1983, pages 48-49.
8. *Above Top Secret -- The Worldwide UFO Coverup*, by Timothy Good, 1989, pages 268 and 486. This book contains an excellent account of Major Keyhoe's work, the infiltration and destruction of NICAP by the CIA, and other U.S. Government activities designed to obscure the UFO phenomenon. The 1951 North Atlantic encounter should be seen in this context. Page 339, discussion of CIA order to debunk UFO reports and discredit witnesses.
9. *UFO Crash Secrets*, by James W. Moseley, 1991, page VI.

10. *UFOs: The Secret Evidence*, a video film by Michael Hesemann, produced by CLIP Film, Munich and 2000 Film Production, Dusseldorf, 1992. This video won six EBE awards at the International UFO Congress and Film Festival, and was the best selling UFO video for four years running from 1994 through 1997.

11. *Beyond Top Secret*, by Timothy Good, 1993.

12. *Geheimsache UFO*, by Michael Hesemann, 1994, pages 59-65, 223, 251-254. This includes the color painting I did in 1970. It also has copies of our report on file in the National Archives. This is a good account of our case, but only available in German.

13. *UFOs The Secret History*, by Michael Hesemann, 1998, Chapter 5, pages 57-64. My 1970 painting of the UFO is on the front cover and on page 234.

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Appendix



FLYING SAUCERS

TOP
SECRET

Major Donald E. Keyhoe
U.S. Marine Corps, Retired
Director of the National Investigations
Committee on Aerial Phenomena



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"I must confess that Major Keyhoe seems to me to have established his case beyond question—that the flying saucers are indeed real, and that the secret behind them, whatever it may be, is known to the U. S. Air Force, which has been investigating them far more thoroughly and seriously than most of us have believed from the government's own contradictory statements."

—*Columbus Dispatch*

"Major Keyhoe is far from being a newcomer in the saucer field, as he was one of the first to discuss them seriously and has been an invaluable gadfly in keeping the armed forces from stamping 'top secret' on reports of sightings. He believes that the saucers are real and that they do come from another planet, and indicates strongly that the Air Force thinks so too."

—*Springfield Republican*

"Major Keyhoe's reports are well-documented, soberly presented, and amazing, so amazing, indeed, that literal-minded people may back away from the conclusions."

—*Los Angeles Daily News*

"Many high officials still scoff at the authenticity of these unexplained objects, but after reading Keyhoe's authorized reports . . . even the skeptic must admit there is more than an even chance these 'unknowns' are something from another planet."

—*Navy News Review*

"For several years Major Keyhoe has devoted full time to saucer investigations. Among saucer 'believers' generally, he enjoys the distinction of offering the most practical and plausible explanation for the strange phenomena."

—*Cleveland Press*



11-57E/2

Major Donald E. Keyhoe,

U. S. Marine Corps, Ret.

*Director, National Investigations
Committee on Aerial Phenomena*

FLYING SAUCERS:

TOP SECRET



G. P. Putnam's Sons New York



03587253

To Robert Wilson Gardner

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Foreword

*National Investigations Committee
on Aerial Phenomena,
1536 Connecticut Avenue,
Washington 6, D.C.
February 3, 1960*

Today, as we prepare to explore outer space, our leading astronomers agree that millions of other worlds must exist, and that some may have civilizations farther advanced than our own. In 1959, the United States Government accepted this belief, setting up an official station to listen for possible messages from nearby solar systems.

There is now full proof—despite strong efforts to hide the fact—that the earth is under close observation by one or more of these advanced worlds. Since the explosion of the first A-bomb, hundreds of officially verified reports, by pilots and other technically trained observers, have proved that intelligently controlled machines, superior to any earth-made craft, are systematically exploring our planet.

First called "flying saucers," then officially labeled UFOs—Unidentified Flying Objects—by the United States Air Force, these strange machines have been seen in increasing numbers, in direct proportion to our atomic-bomb tests and the launching of artificial satellites and space probes.

Publicly, the official attitude is still one of debunking the "saucers" and explaining away sightings—a policy made possible by military secrecy orders. But behind the scenes, a far different attitude exists, as shown by the evidence in this book. Further proof, just received, is shown by the offi-

cial instructions of the Air Force Inspector General to Operations and Training commands. On December 24, 1959, under the heading, **UFOS SERIOUS BUSINESS**, the Inspector General gave these directions regarding UFO reports:

"Unidentified flying objects—sometimes treated lightly by the press and referred to as "flying saucers"—must be rapidly and accurately identified as serious USAF business . . ."¹

The main concern of the Air Force, stated the Inspector General, is whether the object is a threat to the defense of the United States, and secondly, whether it contributes to technical or scientific knowledge. Adding that UFO reports will tend to increase, the Inspector General then instructed Air Force bases to designate investigation officers, each one supplied with a Geiger counter, a camera, binoculars and other equipment. The public, concluded the Inspector General, should be given realistic explanations.

So far, there is no indication of any change in the official debunking policy. It was this policy which led to creation of the National Investigations Committee on Aerial Phenomena over three years ago. A private organization, with members in the armed forces, Government agencies and many professions and trades, NICAP was created to learn the facts about UFOs and to make them public.

In a majority vote, the NICAP Board of Governors has publicly confirmed Air Force censorship and withholding of UFO reports, a policy declared to be inherently dangerous. In order to end the secrecy, NICAP has repeatedly urged that open Congressional hearings be held. An increasing number of congressmen now favor such hearings, but there is still powerful resistance.

If that resistance continues to block open hearings, it is hoped that this book will bring sufficient public support to end the secrecy on this vitally important subject. The following chapters include all the important evidence presented to individual congressmen and committee chairmen, including details of the behind-the-scenes battle against censorship.

¹ Number 26, Volume XI; see facsimile at the end of this book.

As indicated in the text, the main points are backed by documentary evidence; this is available for inspection at the NICAP office in Washington, except for a few documents listed as confidential, which are certified as genuine by Board members and the Secretary of NICAP.

I wish to express my thanks and appreciation to all the NICAP members in the fifty states and foreign countries who have backed our investigation by contributing reports, evaluations, technical opinions and financial support. It is impossible to name the hundreds who have been outstanding in their services, but I am especially indebted to Mr. Richard H. Hall and Miss Elizabeth A. Kendall of the NICAP staff; Mr. Don Neill, Miss Ruth Heisey, Mr. Richard Lechaux, Washington member-volunteers; Miss Miriam Brookman, president of our New York City affiliate, and Mr. Arthur Campbell, president of the Kansas City affiliate.

NICAP advisers not named in the text, but who also contributed valuable services, include astronomer Kenneth Steinmetz, Professor Robert L. Hall, Warrant Officer D. C. Newhouse, First Officer W. R. Peters, Pan American Airlines, Mr. Wilbert B. Smith, former chief of the Canadian UFO project, and Mr. Patrick Lucey, President, Society of American Engineers.

In addition I wish to thank Mr. John DuBarry, Miss Isabel Davis, Mr. Lex Mebane and Mr. Ted Bloecher, of the New York Civilian Saucer Intelligence, and the many others who supplied valuable aid in the fight against unwarranted censorship.

We welcome any new information or assistance that will help in speeding a public Congressional investigation. Though we urge that sources release their names, we shall, if specifically requested, withhold names and identifying details.

DONALD E. KEYHOE
Major, U.S. Marine Corps, Ret.
Director of NICAP

CHAPTER I

Encounter Above the Atlantic

The Navy sighting was dynamite.

It was early in '59 when I learned of this hidden report—a startling encounter with a UFO (Unidentified Flying Object). The lead came in a brief message from Admiral Delmer S. Fahrney, former Navy missile chief, whom I had known for years:

*MY SKIPPER
IN DETROIT
1956-1958*

→ Captain James Taylor, USN, Ret., has an important UFO sighting made by a naval pilot and his crew. Call him at Spacetrionics, Inc., in Washington, District 7-9481.

That night, when Captain Taylor gave me this dramatic Navy report, I could see why it had never been released to the public. Later, Admiral Fahrney and I met at the Army-Navy Club and discussed the details. Fahrney knew, as I

did, of other hidden UFO cases—some of them highly significant. But this one stood out in importance.

I TOLD CAPT. TAYLOR IN 1957

It had happened in 1956. FEB. 10, 1951

(RSD-3)

DOUGLAS
SKYMASTER

Cruising at 19,000 feet, a Navy (R7V-2) transport—a four-engine Super-Constellation—was flying west across the Atlantic Ocean. The next stop was Gander, Newfoundland. Final destination, Naval Air Station, Patuxent, Maryland.

(ARGENTINA)

(TEST)

The night was clear, visibility unlimited.

(PC GRAHAM BETHUNE)

(RARS
CONTINUED)

In the senior pilot's seat, Commander George Benton was checking the dim-lit instruments.¹ At thirty-four, Benton had a decade of Navy flying behind him. He had made the Atlantic crossing more than two hundred times.

(28)

Back in the cabin were two extra Navy air crews, en route home from foreign duty. Most of these men were asleep. Including Benton's regular and relief crews, there were nearly thirty airmen—pilots, navigators and flight engineers—aboard the Constellation.

(STEVE MASTER)

As Commander Benton finished his cockpit check, he glanced out at the stars. Then he leaned forward, puzzled. A few minutes before, the sea below had been dark. Now there was a cluster of lights, like a village, about twenty-five miles ahead.

(25)

Benton looked over at his co-pilot, Lieutenant Peter J. Mooney.

(LT. FRED WATKINSON)

"What do you make of those lights?"

Mooney peered down, startled.

"Looks like a small town!"

"That's what I thought." Benton quickly called the navigator, Lieutenant Alfred C. Erdman. "We must be way off course. There's land down there."

(LT. NJP MOGER)

"It can't be land." Erdman hurried forward from his map table. "That last star sight shows—"

He broke off, staring down at the clustered lights.

"Well?" said Benton.

¹ Since the commander and most of his crew are still on active duty, names have been changed.

"They must be ships," said Erdman. "Maybe a rendezvous for some special operation."

"They don't look like ships," said Benton. He called Radioman John Wiggins. "No word of any unusual ship movements, Wiggins reported. And no signals from the location of the lights. If they were ships, they were keeping radio silence."

(Q.R.
SHEVER)

"Wake up those other crews," Benton told Erdman. "Maybe somebody can dope it out."

(BETHUNE)

(TINGDON)

In a few moments, two or three airmen crowded into the cockpit. Benton cut off the automatic pilot, banked to give them and the men in the cabin a better view.

As the transport began to circle, the strange lights abruptly dimmed. Then several colored rings appeared, began to spread out. One, Benton noticed, seemed to be growing in size.

Behind him, someone gave an exclamation. Benton took another look. That luminous ring wasn't on the surface—it was something rushing up toward the transport.

"What the devil is it?" said Mooney.

"Don't know," muttered Benton. He rolled the Constellation out of its turn to start a full-power climb. Then he saw it was useless. The luminous ring could catch them in seconds.

The glow, he now saw, came from the rim of some large, round object. It reached their altitude, swiftly took shape as a giant disc-shaped machine.

(RSD-3 STEVE MASTER)

Dwarfing the Constellation, it raced in toward them.

"It's going to hit us!" said Erdman.

Benton had known normal fear, but this was nightmare. Numbed, he waited for the crash.

Suddenly the giant disc tilted. Its speed sharply reduced, it angled on past the port wing.

The commander let out his breath. He looked at Mooney's white face, saw the others' stunned expressions. Watching out the port window, he cautiously started to bank. He stopped as he saw the disc.

It had swung around, was drawing abreast, pacing them at about one hundred yards. For a moment he had a clear glimpse of the monster.

Its sheer bulk was amazing; its diameter was three to four times the Constellation's wing span. At least thirty feet thick at the center, it was like a gigantic dish inverted on top of another. Seen at this distance, the glow along the rim was blurred and uneven. Whether it was an electrical effect, a series of jet exhausts or light from openings in the rim, Benton could not tell. But the glow was bright enough to show the disc's curving surface, giving a hint of dully reflecting metal. *BETHUNE*

Though Benton saw no signs of life, he had a feeling they were being observed. Fighting an impulse to dive away, he held to a straight course. Gradually, the strange machine pulled ahead. Tilting its massive shape upward, it quickly accelerated and was lost against the stars.

Peggy Commander Benton reached for his microphone, called Gander Airport and identified himself.

"You show any other traffic out here?" he asked the tower.

"We had something on the scope near you," Gander told him. "But we couldn't get an answer."

"We saw it," Benton said grimly. "It was no aircraft."

He gave the tower a concise report, and back at Gander teletype messages were rushed to the U.S. Air Defense Command, the Commanding Officer, Eastern Sea Frontier, the Director of Air Force Intelligence and the Air Technical Intelligence Center.

ARGENTIA
When the Constellation landed at Gander, Air Force Intelligence officers met the transport. From the start, it was plain they accepted the giant disc sighting as fact. For two hours, Benton and the rest were carefully interrogated, separately and together: *How close did the object come? What was its size . . . estimated rate of climb . . . any electrical interference noted . . . what happened to the other luminous rings?*

From the answers to scores of questions, the majority opinion emerged. The flying disc was between 350 and 400

feet in diameter, and apparently metallic. No interference with ignition noted; instruments not observed and radio not operating during this brief period. Time for the giant disc to climb to the transport's altitude, between five and eight seconds, indicated speed between 1,400 and 2,200 knots; the disc had accelerated above this speed on departure.

Not all the men in the cabin had seen the luminous rings. Of those who had, most were watching the huge disc approach and did not see the "rings" disappear. If they, too, were flying discs, in a rendezvous as some suggested, they apparently had raced off while the other one was checking on the Constellation. *RSD-3 SRYMASTER*

At one point, an Intelligence captain asked Benton if he had seen any indication of life aboard the disc.

"No, but it was intelligently controlled, that's certain." Benton looked at him closely. "That size, it would hardly be remote-controlled, would it?"

"I couldn't say," replied the Air Force man. Nor would he tell what the Gander Airport radar had shown about the disc's speed and maneuvers.

"What's behind all this?" demanded Mooney. "Up to now, I believed the Air Force. You people say there aren't any flying saucers—"

"Sorry, I can't answer any questions," said the captain.

"Why not? After a scare like that, we've got a right to know what's going on."

The Intelligence officer shook his head. "I can't answer any questions," he repeated.

As quickly as possible, Intelligence reports with full details were flashed to the four Defense commanders already notified, with an extra message for the Director of Naval Intelligence. *NATC*

After the Constellation reached Patuxent, the air crews were interviewed again, by a Navy order. Each man made a written report, with his opinion of what he had seen.

Five days later, *Commander* Benton had a phone call from a scientist in a high government agency. "I'm informed you had a close-up UFO sighting. I'd like to see you."

Benton checked, found the man was cleared by the Navy. Next day, the scientist appeared, showed his credentials, listened intently to Benton's report. Then he unlocked a dispatch case and took out some photographs.

"Was it like any of these?"

BETHUNE

At the third picture, Benton stopped him.

"That's it!" He looked sharply at the scientist. "Somebody must know the answers, if you've got photographs of the things."

The other man took the pictures.

"I'm sorry, Commander." He closed his dispatch case and left.

At the time when I learned of this case, I had served for two years as Director of the National Investigations Committee on Aerial Phenomena. In '56, NICAP had been organized as a private, nonprofit organization to determine the facts about UFOs. By January of '59, its membership covered all forty-nine (now fifty) states and thirty foreign countries, excluding the USSR.

Since early in 1957, NICAP's policies and operations had been guided by a Board of Governors including Vice-Admiral R. H. Hillenkoetter, former Director of the super-secret Central Intelligence Agency; Dr. Earl Douglass, religious writer and columnist; Major Dewey Fournet, former Pentagon monitor of the Air Force UFO project; Mr. J. B. Hartranft, president of the 82,000-member Aircraft Owners and Pilots Association; Colonel R. B. Emerson, U.S. Army Reserve; Mr. Frank Edwards, veteran TV and radio commentator; Professor Charles A. Maney, physicist, Defiance University; Reverend Albert Baller, Robbins Memorial Church, Greenfield, Massachusetts; Rear Admiral H. B. Knowles, USN, Ret.; Dr. Marcus Bach, educator, author and lecturer, University of Iowa; and Reverend Leon C. Le Van, New Jerusalem Christian Church, Pittsburgh. (Except for Reverend Le Van, this is the present Board.)

During its two years of active investigation, NICAP had acquired special advisers including rocket and space experts, aeronautical engineers, flight surgeons, astronomers, elec-

tronics experts, military, commercial and private pilots, and specialists in many other related fields.

Among our regular members were congressmen, government officials, newsmen, doctors, lawyers—a cross section of many professions and trades.

By this time, our UFO-reporting network covered most of the globe. Besides our regular channels, we had important inside sources, in the armed forces and elsewhere. Without violating security, they had given us leads to crucial UFO information kept from the press.

Since we had established, without any doubt, that the UFOs were neither secret United States or USSR devices, the Board and most of our members believed the censorship wrong. By now, NICAP's policy was well known: To end the secrecy, and to determine what the UFOs were, where they came from, and why they were operating in our skies. By concentrating on facts, we had tried to offset the frauds and ridiculous claims which had helped to mislead the public.

But in spite of our efforts, and a mass of documented new evidence, the censorship had been tightened. We were redoubling our efforts, with the help of several congressmen, when I learned of the giant flying disc encountered above the Atlantic.

In the first part of '57, Admiral Fahrney had been chairman of the NICAP Board, spearheading our first battle against secrecy, and he quickly recognized the value of this startling Navy case.

"If NICAP ever gets Congressional hearings," he said, "the testimony of those air crews would surprise a lot of people."

"It would jolt the whole country," I said. "But Air Force Headquarters is going all out to block hearings. We have a letter to Senator Byrd that proves it."

"How'd you get a copy?"

"Senator Byrd gave it to a NICAP member—the signed original. It's on Secretary of the Air Force letterhead."

"I'd like to see that! Who signed it?"

"Major General W. P. Fisher. He's the Director of Legislative Liaison, represents Secretary Douglas on Capitol Hill. He even denied facts Air Force Intelligence has already admitted."^{*}

"Probably he's just carrying out orders," said Fahrney. "He may not believe in the policy any more than we do."

"Sure, I know. If I were in his place, I'd be trying to stop NICAP, too. It must be a tough job, having to keep denying the UFOs are real, knowing it could blow wide open at any time."

Fahrney nodded. "Especially if Congress held hearings."

"Well, as you know, several congressmen are NICAP members, and now others are looking into the censorship. Senator Goldwater came right out and said the flying saucers are real and the Air Force is clamming up. He should know—he's an Air Force Reserve colonel, and he flies jets."

"Any other senators on record?"

"Yes, Saltonstall, Hennings and Smathers—they wrote NICAP or some of our members. Also about twenty representatives—Osmers, Frelingheusen, Ayres, Moeller, Ashley, Baumhart. . . ."

The admiral raised his eyebrows. "It begins to look like action."

"It's still a battle," I said. "But if we do get hearings, it's almost sure to break the censorship. This Navy case alone should do it, if they let those air crews talk."

The day after I saw Admiral Fahrney I went into the NICAP office, at 1536 Connecticut Avenue, and opened a special file containing official statements on UFO secrecy.

On January 22, 1958, more than a year after Air Force Intelligence had questioned Commander Benton and the Navy air crews, I had appeared on the Armstrong Circle Theater program, "UFO—Enigma of the Skies." Because the Air Force had drastically censored my script, I tried to reveal a Senate committee's inquiries into UFO secrecy. But the

^{*} Original in NICAP files. All documents referred to in footnotes, except confidential reports, are available for inspection.

producer, evidently fearing Air Force reactions, quickly cut me off the air. Only minutes later, Air Force Assistant Secretary Richard E. Horner appeared before the cameras and flatly denied any censorship of the subject.

Realizing he must have known of the giant disc encountered by the Navy men, since all such reports reach top levels, I took out the Air Force-approved script, given to me by the Armstrong Theater, and checked Horner's exact words:

"During recent years, there has been a mistaken belief that the Air Force has been hiding from the public information concerning unidentified flying objects. Nothing could be further from the truth. And I do not qualify this in any way. . . . There is no evidence at hand that objects popularly known as 'flying saucers' actually exist."

Less than twenty-four hours later, in an unguarded moment, the Air Force censorship was fully admitted by the PIO (Public Information Officer) at Langley Air Force Base. Evidently unaware of Horner's broadcast, Captain Gregory H. Oldenburgh sent an official statement to NICAP member Larry W. Bryant, Warwick, Virginia:

The public dissemination of data on unidentified flying objects is contrary to Air Force policy and regulations . . . specifically, Air Force Regulation 200-2.^{*}

In the folder with Captain Oldenburgh's signed letter was a NICAP file copy of AFR 200-2. Two sections had been marked by one of our staff:

Section B-9: In response to local inquiries resulting from any UFO reported in the vicinity of an Air Force base, information regarding a sighting may be released to the press or the general public by the commander of the Air Force base concerned only if it has been *positively identified as a familiar or known object.* [Air Force italics.]

The other marked paragraph was a key to actual Air Force beliefs about UFOs:

^{*} Original in NICAP files.

Section A-8: Since the possibility cannot be ignored that UFOs reported may be hostile or new foreign air vehicles of unconventional design, it is imperative that sightings be reported rapidly, factually, and as completely as possible.⁴

Knowing this, and all the other proof on record, I had wondered how Horner dared make such a public denial. Undoubtedly, he was under strong compulsion, if not direct orders, to keep the UFO story from the American people.

Since then, proof of the secrecy had mounted. One of the frankest admissions had come from the Acting Commandant of the Coast Guard, Rear Admiral J. A. Hirshfield. I got out his letter and was comparing it with Horner's statement when my phone rang.

The call came from Lou Corbin, news director of WFBR in Baltimore. A World War II lieutenant colonel in the Army, Corbin was now a NICAP special adviser. He himself had seen a UFO, and since then he had verified other sightings, reporting them in his newscasts.

"I'll talk fast—I'm six minutes from air time," Corbin told me. "First item. Don't name those two Baltimore test pilots—the ones that the UFO chased."

"Why, what happened?"

"They've been shut up, their company has defense contracts. Now, second item. I just got an advance copy of a new Civil Defense order. It tells all CD members to report UFOs directly to the nearest Air Force base, by phone. It's certainly revealing, an official order to report something that officially doesn't exist."⁵

"Will the Air Force give Civil Defense any answers?"

"Not a chance. It's a one-way deal. Now I'd like to tie this to that Army directive about keeping UFO reports from the public."

"They turned us down—it's classified."

⁴ Copy at NICAP. AFR 200-2 may be secured by writing Air Force Headquarters, the Pentagon, Washington 25, D.C.

⁵ On file at NICAP.

"Then I'll use that. Give me the high spots."

I quickly summed it up. Three weeks before, we had obtained a copy of the official Daily Bulletin put out by the U.S. Continental Army Command at Fort Monroe. Dated December 29, 1958, it warned USCONARC personnel to follow an Intelligence directive issued on May 27, 1958, in confidential reporting of UFOs.⁶

"We asked for a copy," I said. "Here's the answer: 'Security regulations prohibit sending a copy of the USCONARC Intelligence Directive dated May 27, 1958.'"

"Who signed it?"

"A Headquarters colonel—Lawrence J. M. Mulhall."

"Okay, I'm going to blast this runaround," said Corbin. "It'll be on the air in three minutes."

He hung up, and I looked back at the Coast Guard letter. On August 4, 1958, Acting Commandant Hirshfield had answered our request for an important visual-and-radar UFO report by the Coast Guard Cutter *Sebago*. This official report, said the admiral, had been forwarded to the "designated agency in the Department of Defense." Then he added:

Federal law prohibits the release of official files concerning such cases to other than specified channels. I therefore find it necessary to refuse your request for this information.⁸

The Coast Guard refusal had not surprised me. With Air Force Headquarters in charge of the UFO investigation, they—or whoever controlled the policy—had managed to impose the secrecy provisions on most government agencies. In the case of the Coast Guard, the Federal Aviation Agency and the Civil Aeronautics Board, secrecy was secured under a Joint Chiefs of Staff order, JANAP 146; invoking the Espionage Law, this provided heavy penalties for revealing UFO reports.⁹ So far as I knew, the Navy was the only gov-

⁶ On file at NICAP.

⁷ On file at NICAP.

⁸ On file at NICAP.

⁹ On file at NICAP.

ernment department without a secrecy directive, and even without this, few sightings were made public.

So overwhelming was the censorship proof that in August, 1958, the NICAP Board of Governors had publicly protested this secrecy.

"From evidence in NICAP's possession," said the Board, "it is clear that the Air Force has withheld and is still withholding information—including sighting reports—on the subject of unidentified flying objects."

This was unanimously approved by all Board members. To the first statement, a majority had added this warning:

"We believe this policy to be dangerous since it makes it possible for the Soviet Government to claim ownership of UFOs (or flying saucers). Such a false claim might create a serious situation in this country."

Immediately, sharp contradictions had been made by the Air Force. As questions began to be asked on Capitol Hill, the Air Force denials increased, from top levels on down to the hundreds of PIOs in the United States and on foreign duty.

Against all this, a Congressional disclosure of the hidden evidence would hit like an H-bomb. But even with the increased support on Capitol Hill, we had no illusions as to what was ahead. The Air Force would use all its power to keep the truth hidden. With Air Force and Army members muzzled, the battle was on to stop Navy leaks and silence airline pilots. As press reports of sightings dwindled, it almost seemed they had won.

Then came the break—a headlined airline sighting and a veteran airline captain who gamely stood up to the Air Force.

With familiar ridicule tactics, the censors moved in to crush him.

It was a fight they would not soon forget.

CHAPTER II

The Killian Case

The DC-6 was an hour out of Newark when the captain first saw the UFOs.

It was February 24, 1959; the time, 8:20 P.M.

Until then, the trip had been routine. The nonstop Detroit flight, American Airlines 713, had departed from Newark on schedule. In command was a four-million-miler, Captain Peter W. Killian, fifteen years on the airlines. Riding the co-pilot's right-hand seat was First Officer John Dee.

By 8:15, the two stewardesses, Edna LeGate and Beverly Pingree, had finished serving dinner to the thirty-five passengers aboard. The flight was then over Pennsylvania, the roar of its four engines subdued to a drone in the airliner's sound-proofed cabin.

At 8:19, the plane passed over Bradford; altitude 8,500



DATE: February 8, 1951

LOCATION: North Atlantic

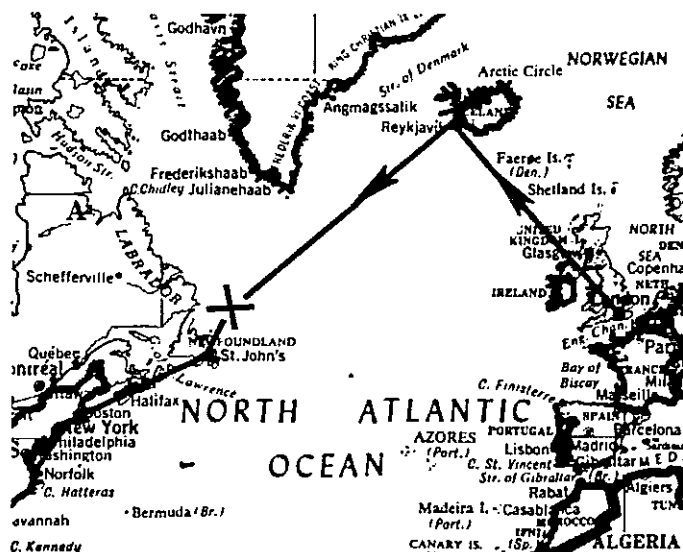
Chapter 1 of Major Donald Keyhoe's last book, *Flying Saucers, Top Secret*, is entitled "Encounter Above the Atlantic." The chapter describes a sighting made in the 1950s by the crew of a U.S. Navy aircraft en route from Iceland to Newfoundland. Keyhoe's source for the report was Captain James Taylor, a retired Naval officer living in Washington, D.C., whose name had been given to Keyhoe by another Naval officer, Admiral D.S. Fahrney, a close friend of the Major.

Taylor learned of the incident in 1956 from a friend and former associate, a Navy pilot who was one of the primary witnesses. This man, a Lieutenant at the time of the sighting and now a Commander, is identified in the book under the fictitious name George Benton. Keyhoe used the pseudonym to protect the officer from publicity, because Benton was still on active duty at the time the book appeared (1960).

In April of this year, NICAP contacted Benton and requested a personal interview, in hopes that the original report could be updated and corrected with first-hand information.

The interview was conducted a few weeks later at Benton's home in New Jersey. It was the first time he had confided details of his experience to anyone except military intelligence and his own friends and associates. His memory of the incident was only slightly affected by the passage of time, since, as he explained, "I have seen nothing like it in all my years of flying."

The sighting occurred in the early morning of February 8, 1951. Benton, 30 years old, was flying an R5D transport, which was returning to the United States from England via Iceland and Newfoundland. Benton had flown the Atlantic many times, having operated seaplanes over the South Atlantic for two years, and been assigned to the Naval Air Station in



Predawn sighting occurred on second leg of trans-Atlantic flight. "X" marks spot where encounter took place.

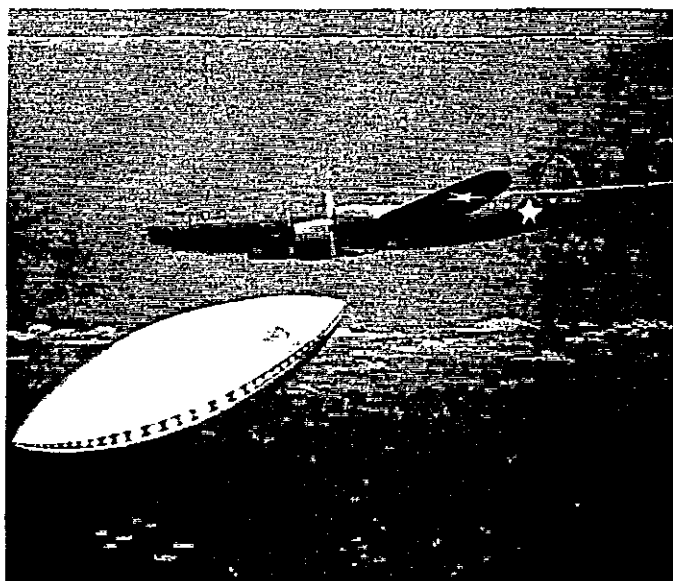
Brooklyn, New York, and later to a flight squadron at Norfolk, Virginia. At the time of the sighting, he was stationed at the Naval Air Test Center in Maryland, where he qualified for 38 types of military aircraft.

The weather on the night of the sighting was excellent. The moon had set, but visibility was still good. As Benton remembers it, "You could make out the horizon clearly but . . . you could not see the white caps on the water clearly."

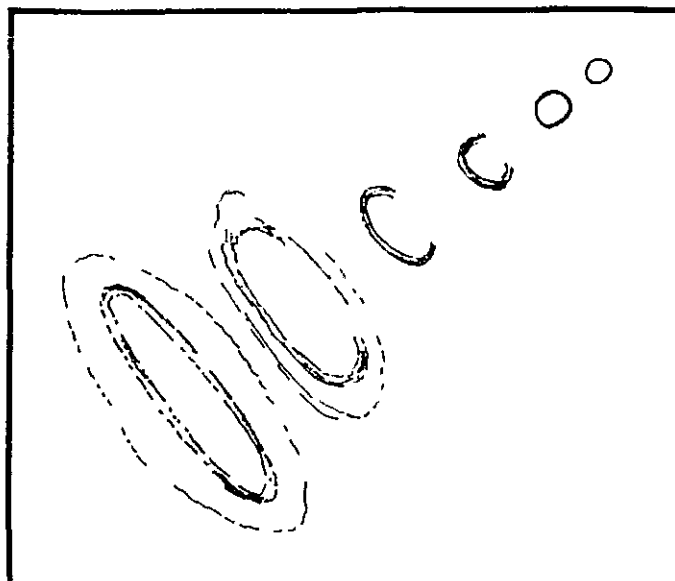
Seated opposite Benton in the co-pilot's seat was the plane commander, Lt. Col. F.K. (identified in Keyhoe's book as Peter Mooney). Back in the plane, asleep, were two extra crews, one a relief crew for Benton's men and the other on board as passengers. The aircraft was flying at 10,000 feet, on due course for Newfoundland. Ground speed was over 200 knots (230 miles per hour).

Approximately three and a half hours out of Iceland, at mid-point in the flight, the plane passed over a weather ship, which was on station below, off the coast of Greenland. The ship reported everything normal.

(Continued next issue.)



Artist version of sighting, based on faulty data, shows too much detail. Night was not this clear, and object did not come this close.



Eyewitness sketch depicts UFO at various stages of its ascent toward aircraft. Shrouded in white glow, object had fiery ring at outer edge.

CASEBOOK

DATE: February 8, 1951

LOCATION: North Atlantic

Crew members and passengers on a Navy R5D aircraft experienced a dramatic sighting in the early morning hours of February 8, 1951, while flying over the North Atlantic (see last month's issue). The details of that experience, as told by the pilot, are published here for the first time. *BETHUNE*

"The aircraft was on automatic-pilot (this was standard procedure during clear weather, so both pilots could watch for other aircraft). Lt. ~~John~~ F.K. and myself were on constant watch for other aircraft. I observed a yellow glow in the distance about 30 to 35 miles away, at about the 1 o'clock position and below the horizon. My impression was that there was a small city ahead, because it was the same glow you get from a group of lights on the surface before you get close enough to pick them out individually.

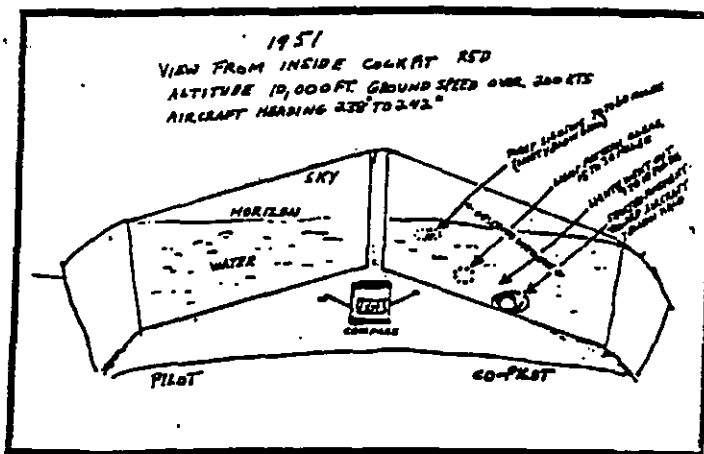
"Knowing that we pass the tip of Greenland, my first thought was that we were behind schedule and had drifted north, but remembering that we had passed over the weather ship, I knew this was not the case. I called F.K.'s attention to the glow and asked him what he thought it was. He said that it looked like we were approaching land. I asked our navigator to check his navigation. He did and replied that we were on flight plan and on course.

"The lights were farther away than we thought because it took us from eight to ten minutes to get close enough to where the lights had a pattern (our ground speed was over three miles per minute), about 15 or 18 miles away. At that time, due to the circular pattern of lights, I got the impression that possibly two ships were tied up together and that lights were strung between them for either transferring cargo from one to the other or that one was in some kind of trouble.

"I asked the navigator to check his ship plot. He replied that there were no ships plotted in this area and that we were not close to the shipping lanes anyway. The radioman also went on the air to the weather ship, which verified that there were no ships in the area.

"Since it was time for Lt. J.'s crew to relieve us, I had the plane captain awaken them. When Lt. J. and Lt. M. came up forward, I pointed the lights out to them. Their only comment was that it had to be a ship because it was on the water and we were overtaking it fast. At this time, we were five to seven miles away; it was about 30 degrees to our right; and we had to look down at about a 45-degree angle. The lights had a definite circular pattern and were bright white.

"Suddenly, the lights went out. There appeared a yellow halo on the water. It turned to an orange, to a fiery red, and then started movement toward us at a fantastic speed, turning to a blueish red around the perimeter. Due to its high speed, its direction of travel, and its size, it looked as though we were going to be engulfed. I quickly disengaged the automatic-pilot and stood by to push the nose of the plane over in hopes that we could pass under it due to the angle it was ascending. The relief crew was standing behind us; everyone began ducking, and a few heads were hit on objects.



Pilot's drawing shows view from cockpit as strange object rose from ocean's surface and approached aircraft on apparent collision course.

"It stopped its movement toward us and began moving along with us about 45 degrees off the bow to the right, about 100 feet or so below us and about 200 to 300 feet in front of us. It was not in a level position; it was tilted about 25 degrees.

"It stayed in this position for a minute or so. It appeared to be from 200 to 300 feet in diameter, translucent or metallic, shaped like a saucer, a purple-red fiery ring around the perimeter and a frosted white glow around the entire object. The purple-red glow around the perimeter was the same type of glow you get around the commutator of an auto generator when you observe it at night.

"When the object moved away from us, it made no turns, as though it was backing up about 170 degrees from the direction that it approached us, and was still tilted. It was only a few seconds before it was out of sight. (Speed estimated in excess of 1500 mph.)

"All of our cameras were within reach, but no one was calm enough to think about taking a picture. Most of us were wondering what it was. Our impression was that this was a controlled craft. It was either hovering over the water or sitting on it, then it detected us and came up to investigate.

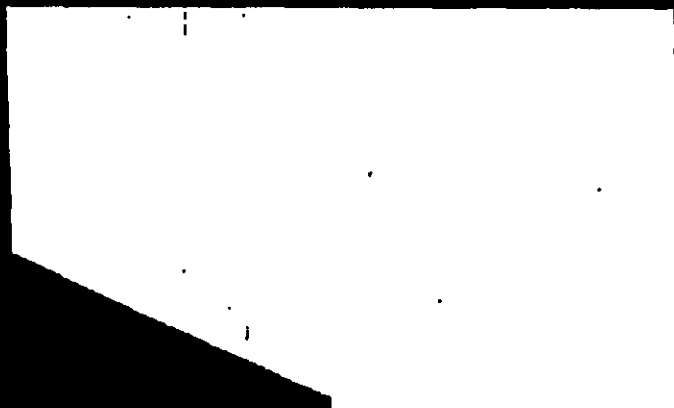
"After Lt. J.'s crew had taken over, I proceeded aft and learned that most of the passengers had observed the same thing. Since I was unable to identify the object, I asked Dr. M., CDR U.S. Navy, if he had observed the object. He replied that he had and that he did not look because it was a flying saucer and he did not believe in such things. I immediately returned to the cockpit and informed the crew to keep quiet about what we observed because it might have been our first sighting of a flying saucer (during those years when you mentioned you had such a sighting, you were believed to be crazy). Lt. J. informed me that it was too late because he had called Gander airfield in Newfoundland to see if the object could be tracked by radar.

"When we landed at Argentia (Newfoundland), we were met by intelligence officers. The types of questions they asked us were like Henry Ford asking about the Model T. You got the feeling that they were putting words in your mouth. It was obvious that there had been many sightings in the same area, and most of the observers did not let the cat out of the bag openly. When we arrived in the United States, we had to make a full report to Navy Intelligence.

"I found out a few months later that Gander radar did track the object in excess of 1800 mph. I did not see the reports made by other members aboard the aircraft. I did talk to the Air Force at Wright-Patterson AFB in 1957 but did not look at the report. They said they had it and many similar reports."

ALIENS FROM SPACE...

THE REAL STORY OF UNIDENTIFIED FLYING OBJECTS



MAJOR DONALD E. KEYHOE

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Here are some of the questions answered in

ALIENS FROM SPACE.

- ▶ Why do the CIA and the Air Force think that UFOs constitute a frightening situation that must be kept from the public at all costs?
- ▶ Why do airline pilots refuse to report UFO encounters to the Air Force? Why are Air Force pilots instructed to pursue UFOs?
- ▶ What is the truth about the University of Colorado project and the Condon Report? What is the truth about the Rand Corporation report (*UFOs: What to Do?*) that confirms CIA control, spaceship evidence, and the very serious nature of the problem?
- ▶ What about the spectacular giant spaceship sightings in Russia?
- ▶ Did UFOs trigger the Great Blackout of 1965? There were sightings just before the blackout, and the experts could not explain the failure of the supposedly infallible grid system. There are also UFO links with other blackouts here and abroad.
- ▶ Have UFOs actually landed on the earth?
- ▶ What can we do to prepare the public for the inevitable meeting with extraterrestrial visitors?

6

Invisible Control

It was early in '62 when the CIA struck at NICAP, to block a threatened showdown which would have ended the cover-up. Here for the first time are the full details of that incredible operation and its stunning climax.

The explosive situation which led to the CIA action built up on Capitol Hill in 1961. In the preceding session, NICAP had sent a confidential report to Congress with proof of UFO reality, the censorship, and increasing hazards from secrecy.

The confidential report was approved by the NICAP Board of Governors, including veteran military men with extensive knowledge of the UFO evidence: Vice-Adm. R. H. Hillenkoetter, former CIA director; Rear Adm. H. B. Knowles and Army Reserve Col. Robert B. Emerson, both of whom had made careful evaluations of the UFO reports; former AF Monitor Dewey Fournet, and J. B. Hartranft, Jr., an AF lieutenant colonel in World War II, since then president of the worldwide Aircraft Owners and Pilots Association.

In March 1961, House Majority Leader McCormack privately told me he had urged an investigation by the Science and Astronautics Committee, headed by Congressman Overton Brooks.

By this time, after studying the NICAP confidential report, scores of legislators had come out against UFO secrecy, among them Senators Dodd, Goldwater, Keating, Kefauver, Prox-

mire and Smathers, and Congressmen Addonizio, Baumhart, Downing, Hardy, Metcalf, Scherer, and L. T. Johnson.

Representative Hiestand urged the Secretary of the AF to reveal the facts. Representative Lindsay, later the mayor of New York, called UFO sightings a matter of vital importance. "The security of the U.S.," he said, "does not always demand total secrecy. . . . The American people are fully capable of understanding the nature of these problems."

Representative Leonard Wolf, a member of the Space Committee, told the House of Representatives: "I believe that publication of the NICAP Report (with one confidential section on foreign angles deleted) will help to reduce the dangers cited by Vice-Admiral Hillenkoetter and the other NICAP officials." Stressing that the NICAP Report was a careful evaluation in contrast to frauds and delusions about UFOs, Wolf strongly urged open hearings.

In May of '61 a UFO investigation was announced, to be carried out by three members of the House Space Committee. The subcommittee was to be headed by Congressman Joseph E. Karth of Minnesota. Karth had already publicly criticized the censorship, and he insisted that the hearings should be open.

An AF fight against hearings had been started by Maj. Gen. W. P. Fisher, Director of Legislative Liaison. In letters and conversations with lawmakers he hammered away with this argument: "Hearings would only benefit the sensation seekers and publishers of science fiction." Other ranking HQ officers followed up, trying to kill the investigation. But the drive for hearings was moving too rapidly.

In August, Chairman Brooks of the Space Committee gave the AF its hardest setback. Until then, he had not favored hearings, though he had reluctantly agreed on the UFO subcommittee, after strong urging by Majority Leader McCormack. But he still refused to sanction open meetings or even privately examine NICAP's documented evidence.

But in early August something caused a surprising change.

Without explaining what had happened, Chairman Brooks scheduled a private conference with Admiral Hillenkoetter and me. We were asked to bring a cross section of our strongest and best-documented evidence, also proof of official censorship and an explanation of the secrecy dangers. Later on I learned that Brooks had a deep respect for the admiral's achievement in organizing the CIA and directing it for three years, besides a high regard for his brilliant Navy record. In ignoring the NICAP confidential report, he had failed to realize that Hillenkoetter was a Board member almost from the beginning.

The conference was set for August 24, but our hopes were quickly ended. Congressman Brooks was taken seriously ill, and he died soon afterward. His successor was Congressman George P. Miller, who bluntly announced he would not order hearings.

The chances of ending the cover-up seemed almost zero. But in February of '62 a congressman who had strongly supported Karth asked me to come to his office.

"There's another way to break this," he said. "I've talked it over with some of my colleagues and I'm sure we can count on Karth, Downing, Moss, Kornegay—as many as we want on the House side. Maybe we can get McCormack, if it won't jeopardize his Majority Leader position. In the Senate, I'm certain we can get Keating, Goldwater, Proxmire, Dodd and two or three others already on the record against UFO secrecy.

"Now first, we want you to give us one of the hottest cases NICAP's got, fully documented. It's got to be powerful and exciting, with enough expert witnesses so it'll hit the front pages and the network newscasts."

"I know one big case that would do it," I said. "But without hearings, how—?"

"I'll explain in a minute. Tell me about this report."

"Admiral Del Fahrney gave me the lead to it—he's been a NICAP member since he retired as the Navy missile chief. I can get him to confirm it to you. The detailed report was

obtained from the chief witness by Capt. James Taylor, and Fahrney arranged for him to verify the whole thing for me. You can double-check this with Taylor if you want to. He's retired now, and he told me I could use his name."

"Okay," said the congressman. "Give me a rundown."

On the night of the UFO encounter, a four-engine Navy transport was flying west over the Atlantic, its altitude 19,000 feet. At the controls was Cmdr. George Brent, a Navy pilot for ten years. (To protect the officer his name has been changed.) Brent had crossed the Atlantic more than two hundred times. On this trip he was bringing two flight crews home from special duty in Europe. Including his own crew there were over twenty-five pilots, navigators and flight engineers aboard the transport.

The plane was about fifty miles from Gander Airport, Newfoundland, when Brent saw a cluster of lighted objects ahead. Apparently they were on the surface of the ocean, or close to it.

As the commander circled for a better look all the lights suddenly dimmed. Then they swiftly spread out and disappeared—except for one which streaked up at the transport. Within seconds, the object reached the plane's altitude, now clearly visible as a huge flying disc with a glow around the rim. To the stunned men in the cockpit it seemed about to hit them head on. Then it tilted sharply and shot to one side.

Reducing speed, the flying disc swung around to pace the transport. To the dazed men in the cockpit and the cabin it was an incredible sight. The UFO was enormous, well over 300 feet in diameter and at least thirty feet thick at the center. From the glow around the rim the Navy men could see the reflecting surface, apparently smooth metal.

After about ten seconds the big disc tilted up steeply, accelerating to an estimated speed of over 2,000 knots before it disappeared.

When Brent radioed Gander a tower operator told him they

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had tracked the UFO on radar. When the plane landed, the entire crew was interrogated by AF Intelligence officers. At their destination, Patuxent Naval Air Station in Maryland, Brent and the rest were questioned again by Naval Intelligence and required to sign full reports. Later, a government scientist (supposedly from the CIA) confidentially showed Brent secret UFO photos—one portraying a disc like the one over the Atlantic. In a final interview, the commander was interviewed by Air Technical Intelligence officers at Wright-Patterson AFB. But none of the Navy or Air Force men, or the government scientist, would answer any questions about the UFOs.

"That's a powerful case," the congressman said. "It's exactly what we need."

"Those witnesses are probably afraid of reprisals," I told him. "They may not agree to a public report."

"Tell them we'll guarantee immunity. If you have any trouble I'm sure Admiral Hillenkoetter can persuade them to appear."

"You mean he's in on this?"

"Not yet, but we expect him to be. Now, here's the strategy. We intend to call a press conference—there's nothing to stop members of Congress from getting together and talking with the press. We want Admiral Hillenkoetter to spearhead the show. With his terrific Navy record and being CIA director three years the press will play it up as a top-level deal.

"But first we'll have a private bipartisan meeting, not connected with any committee, and we'll keep it under wraps. We'll have Hillenkoetter and you and two or three NICAP Board members there, after we've lined up those Navy witnesses. We'll have that commander give us the report first, then the other witnesses, so we can be sure it's airtight. We should also go over two or three other hot cases you and the other NICAP Board members can certify, and any new documentary proof of censorship since your report to Congress."

"There's one thing that should have a big impact," I said.

"In the fall of '61 we managed to get a photocopy of an AF Intelligence sketch of a flying disc. It was taken from a restricted manual for AF Intelligence officers, entitled AFM 200-3. We can use it because somebody slipped up and forgot to reclassify it as Confidential when the Restricted classification was canceled."

"What does it show?" asked the congressman.

"There's an AF bomber in the lower foreground. Above it is a typical flying disc with a domed center, coming in toward the bomber. But here's the important part. This official sketch is linked with a key statement in the manual: 'The Air Technical Intelligence Center is responsible for the prevention of technological surprise.' So here is AF Intelligence, in this hidden manual, implying a possible 'technological surprise' by UFOs after flatly denying they exist. The payoff is this claim in AF Special Project Report 14, p. 93:

"It is still impossible to develop a picture of what a flying saucer is. . . . Out of 4,000 people who said they saw flying saucers, sufficiently detailed descriptions were given in only 12 cases. Having culled the cream of the crop, it is still impossible to develop a picture. . . . to derive a verified model . . ."

"That's very good," the congressman said. "We'll make copies of that photostat and those AF statements, and give them to the press. As I see it, we'll have McCormack or Karth open the press conference, with Goldwater or some other senator confirming the purpose. They'll come right out and say this congressional group is seriously concerned about the UFO problem and the censorship. Then Admiral Hillenkoetter will take over. He'll repeat his statement that UFOs are real objects under intelligent control and that the AF is hiding the truth. Then he can produce the Navy witnesses in that Atlantic case. When they finish with their story we can follow up with a few other strong NICAP-verified cases, and Hillenkoetter can go into the proof of secrecy, and the dangers from covering up. To wind it up, the congressional

group will go on record as demanding an end to official secrecy. If it's handled right, with network TV along with the wire services, it'll blow the lid off. Unless the Air Force gives in, Congress will have to hold a full-scale investigation—an open one."

"If you can do this without scaring the public, it should be a big start toward preparing people."

"We'll use the same approach the Fournet group intended," the congressman assured me. "You said they were going to play up the lack of any proven hostility. We'll do the same—maybe Admiral Hillenkoetter should open on that angle. Naturally some people will be a little frightened, but if we handle it carefully I don't think they'll get hysterical. I'm counting on Hillenkoetter for that. You think there's any doubt he'll go along?"

"No, I'm almost certain he'll agree; he's hit the secrecy pretty hard. I've known him since we were classmates at the Naval Academy. If he does take it on he won't pull any punches."

"That's why we want him. Will you sound him out?"

"Sure. His office is in New York—he's head of a shipping line. I'll fly up if necessary; I'd rather not phone about it. But he's expected down here in a few days—"

"That'll be okay," said the congressman. "Let me know as soon as you can."

The more I thought over this breakthrough scheme the better it looked. Most of this Congress group had openly opposed the secrecy. From personal knowledge, I was sure that McCormack, Karth and Goldwater would put up a real fight. Karth, I knew, had counted heavily on NICAP evidence and assistance in open hearings. After a misunderstanding about protocol, which I quickly corrected, Congressman Karth wrote me that he expected strong NICAP evidence of the interplanetary answer. It was his belief, he said, that we would produce proof of UFO reality in a hearing—proof

that UFOs "actually were craft (of sorts) from other planets." Otherwise, he told me, he would not have been interested in holding hearings. On receiving details of the available proof, he accepted NICAP's offer of full co-operation. Indicating his determination to resist any possible pressure, he sent me this underlined statement:

"I am not a captive of the Air Force."

If Hillenkoetter acted as spearhead, it would of course add greatly to the national publicity. From the start, his Navy record had been outstanding. A star man at Annapolis, he was graduated Number 20 in a class of 457. He had served with distinction in submarines, on destroyers and battleships. In his early career, he carried out several diplomatic missions in Europe and South America. During his attaché service in Paris, Madrid, Lisbon and Rome he won high foreign decorations, including that of "Officer in the French Legion of Honor."

Hillenkoetter was executive officer of the U.S.S. West Virginia when World War II broke out, and he was wounded when the Japanese sank the battleship. After a tour as Chief of Intelligence in the Pacific, he went on to action in the Solomons and New Hebrides, followed by a special assignment as Director of War Planning and Control. He was present at the Japanese surrender on the U.S.S. Missouri, and afterward he was given command of the ship.

In 1947, President Truman promoted Hillenkoetter to vice-admiral and made him the first director of the new Central Intelligence Agency. After three years he returned to naval duty, serving as the Navy Inspector General. Then in 1957 he retired and became head of a New York shipping line.

In his five years on the NICAP Board he had played an important role in combating UFO secrecy. If he did accept the Congress group role, it probably would result in the biggest break in the cover-up.

Before contacting Hillenkoetter, I took steps to locate Commander "Brent." I knew his real name, but phoning

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Naval Personnel for his present station could be a mistake. To avoid any link with the UFO subject I used a go-between, a friend who dealt with various government departments as a personnel specialist. Though he had a serious interest in the UFO riddle he kept it quiet. I knew he could be trusted—we had exchanged suppressed information several times, with no resultant leaks. As he is now in private industry I can safely disclose the part he played, but not his name. I'll call him Jack Morton.

I had a special reason for selecting Morton. In 1959 he had met a Navy pilot stationed in Washington. After they became close friends Morton mentioned his interest in UFOs. Later the pilot revealed he had a close sighting while on a Navy transport. When Morton gave me the details, in confidence, I suspected this was the Atlantic encounter case. But the pilot refused any contact with NICAP, fearing a possible leak to the Air Force.

When I saw Morton, at his home, I told him the situation and he agreed to find out "Brent's" station. I asked if he thought the Navy might have a "flag" on the commander's file—a notice to refuse information and report any queries.

"I don't think so," said Morton. "That was some time back. But to play safe I'll just say I know the commander and I heard he was being transferred here. Then I'll ask for his address so I can write him. It should be routine."

"Thanks," I said. "Say, about that Navy pilot you know who had a sighting. If he really was one of the witnesses in that Atlantic case, do you think he'd agree to join the commander at that press conference?"

"I doubt it. He took eight months to decide on telling me about that sighting."

"If he really was one of those witnesses he could be a big help. He might get in touch with some he knew personally and ask them to join in. The congressman who told me about this said they'd guarantee immunity."

"How could they be sure? Maybe if Admiral Hillenkoetter

promised to protect them they'd agree. I'll ask this pilot during the weekend, that is, if this was the same case. Meantime, I'll get the dope on the commander and phone you tomorrow."

But the next day passed with no word. Morton's secretary told me he had taken time off, but calls to his home went unanswered. The following night, after repeated calls, I drove out to his house. No one came to the door, but soon after I returned home Morton telephoned.

"I've got to make this quick," he said hurriedly. "That Navy call raised hell—they did have a flag on that commander. A clerk said she'd check on his station, but she didn't call back. In less than an hour two CIA agents showed up at my office. They had me get rid of my secretary—"

"Hold it a second, Jack," I broke in.

"Don't stop me—I'm taking a big chance calling you. Those two agents really gave me the third degree. They made me tell them who wanted the commander's address and why. I could tell that the Congress meeting deal worried them. They grilled me until I told them about the whole plan and Admiral Hillenkoetter. That's all there is—"

Morton stopped for a moment. I heard his voice indistinctly, then he came back on.

"My wife's scared to death. I could be in trouble calling you—they ordered me not to see you or tell you anything. But I saw you at the house tonight and I knew you'd keep on until you got to me. Look, I've got to go—for heaven's sake don't try to call or see me again."

After Morton hung up, I felt a sudden guilt at involving him in this operation. And yet we had no reason to expect trouble. Twice before this, Morton had acted as go-between and secured the addresses of military witnesses in fairly important cases. There had been no repercussions. Also, both the CIA and the AF knew I had the Atlantic encounter report but had made no attempt to contact the witnesses. The main reason was a suggestion by Admiral Fahrney, in 1959,

that we plan to use this startling case and the Navy air crews' testimony when we got congressional hearings. We were both confident that the Navy Department would produce these witnesses without resisting a congressional committee summons.

But apparently the CIA and the AF fully realized the potential danger in this case and had continued their safeguard, even with no sign of trouble.

Whatever the answer, the damage was done now. With the CIA aware of the Congress group plan, it would go all out to block it. There was still one chance. If Admiral Hillenkoetter was determined to go ahead, regardless of opposition, the Congress group would probably back him in an open fight. I knew that he should be warned about the CIA agents' action—especially since he had not yet been told of the Capitol Hill plan. To avoid endangering Morton I decided to fly to New York for a private meeting.

Next morning I phoned my secretary, Mrs. Lelia Day, from Washington Airport.

"I'm flying to New York. If necessary you can call me at—"

"Wait," she said hastily, "there's an important letter here you should know about. No one else knows about it yet. I could read it to you, but—"

"Hold it. I'll be right in."

When I saw Mrs. Day's face I knew there was bad news. She silently handed me the letter, went out and closed the door.

As I had guessed, the letter was from Hillenkoetter.

Dear Don:

In my opinion, NICAP's investigation has gone as far as possible. I know the UFOs are not U.S. or Soviet devices. All we can do now is wait for some action by the UFOs.

The Air Force cannot do any more under the circumstances. It has been a difficult assignment for them, and I believe we should not continue to criticize their investigations.

I am resigning as a member of the NICAP Board of Governors.

As I reread this incredible letter some of Hillenkoetter's public statements flashed through my mind:

"The UFOs are unknown objects operating under intelligent control. . . . The Air Force is still censoring UFO sightings. Hundreds of authentic reports by veteran pilots and other technically trained observers have been ridiculed or explained away as mistakes, delusions or hoaxes. . . . It is imperative that we learn where the UFOs come from and what their purpose is. The public has a right to know. . . ."

The most important statement of all was the one Hillenkoetter had signed on August 22, 1961, which was sent to Congress after the death of Space Committee Chairman Overton Brooks:

Acting with the majority of the NICAP Board of Governors, I urge immediate Congressional action to reduce the dangers from secrecy about Unidentified Flying Objects. . . . Two dangers are steadily increasing:

1. The risk of accidental war, from mistaking UFO formations for a Soviet surprise attack.
2. The danger that the Soviet Government may, in a critical moment, *falsely* claim the UFOs as secret Russian weapons against which our defenses are helpless.

For the third time I went over the admiral's astonishing letter of resignation. There was no hint that he had been told about the Congress group's exposé plan. Yet it was the only believable explanation. But Hillenkoetter had been absolutely convinced that the cover-up *should* be exposed. How could he have been pressured into this complete reversal?

Threats would not have worked—I knew this tough fighter too well to believe that. The only answer was persuasion at a very high level that it was his duty to help block the Capitol Hill showdown—and to attempt a change in NICAP

policy. But this would still require some powerful reason for continuing the secrecy. That it was some frightening situation, to be kept from the public at all costs, I refused to believe. With all the confidential sources I had established since '49 I would have had at least an inkling. In an effort to find some clue, I went back over all the main points of the UFO evidence. But the cause of the admiral's action was still a mystery.

Regardless of the CIA and AF sincere motives, their long suppression of the truth about UFOs is the greatest public deception in American history.

On October 29, 1962, withholding information from the public was admitted by Defense Department Assistant Secretary Arthur Sylvester. If the ends justified it, he said, it was not wrong to keep the public in the dark. In AF Regulation 11-30, withholding information "in the public interest" is admitted as official policy. In AF Regulation 11-7, it is stated that sometimes information requested by Congress may not be furnished "even in confidence."

In regard to UFOs, the CIA and the AF realize it is impossible to deceive all of Congress and the public. Their aim always has been to keep the *majority* convinced that none of the reports has been correct.

To carry out this program, they have been forced to resort to the "Big Lie" technique to insure success. But in doing this they have built up a foundation for dangerous alarm, if an outbreak of mass UFO operations suddenly disproved the false claims.

After several publicized landings in 1964, the UFO censorship officials were warned that sudden proof of UFO reality might cause an uncontrollable wave of fear. Several AF Headquarters officers were considering, belatedly, what steps to take in such an emergency, when the first phase of a new crisis abruptly began.

Increasing from the first week in '65, UFO encounter re-

ports grew into an avalanche. As the months went on, bizarre stories of new discoveries and alien beings became public. Before the end of the year, the censors faced the worst crisis since the UFO surveillance began. And the end was not in sight.

JUNE 1973

In this Issue:

SIX PLANES AND 27 MEN
DISAPPEARED ON THE FAMOUS
LOST PATROL
WHAT REALLY HAPPENED?

NAVAL AVIATION

NEWS



Crew members and passengers on an R5D (C-54) experienced a dramatic UFO sighting in the pre-dawn hours of a North Atlantic flight in the early 1950s. Details of the interesting occurrence, as told some years later by the pilot, Lt. "B," are excerpted here through the cooperation of the National Investigations Committee on Aerial Phenomena (NICAP).

At the time of the event, ^{BETHUNE} Lt. B. was 28 ~~30~~ years old, experienced in both North and South Atlantic flight, with qualifications in 38 types of aircraft.

westerly course for Newfoundland, ground speed 200 knots. Three and a half hours out of Iceland, midpoint in the flight, they passed over a weather ship on station off the coast of Greenland. The ship reported normal conditions.

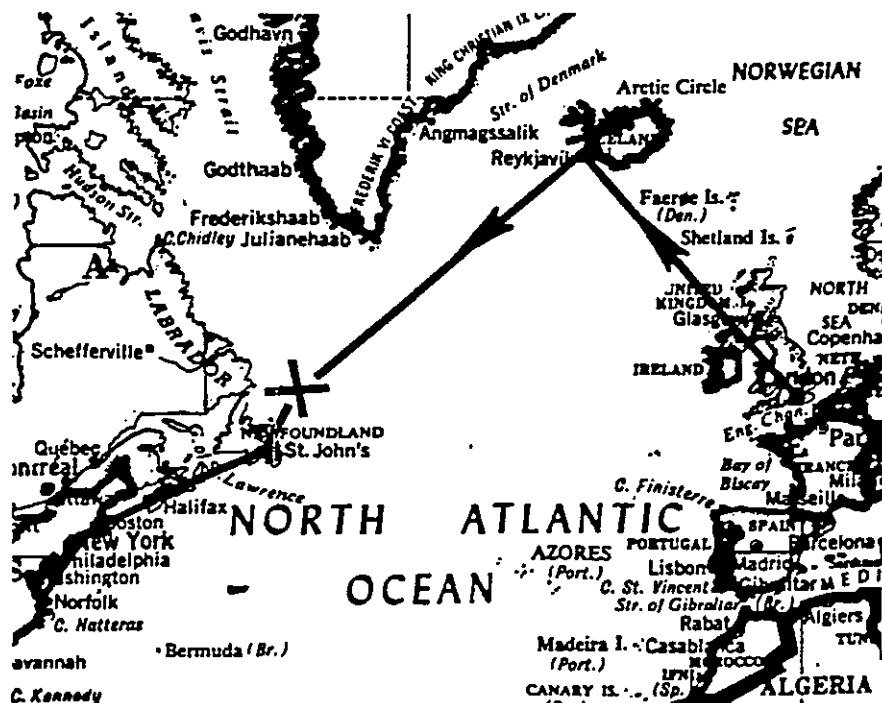
The aircraft was on autopilot. Lt. K. and myself were on constant watch for other aircraft. I observed a yellow glow in the distance about 30 to 35 miles away, at about the one o'clock position and below the horizon. My impression was that there was a small city ahead, because it was the same glow you get from a group of lights on the surface before you get close enough to pick them out individually.

"Knowing that our course took us past the tip of Greenland, my first thought was that we hadn't yet reached it, that we were behind schedule and had drifted north, but remembering that we had passed over the weather ship, I realized this was not the case. I called K.'s attention to the glow and asked him what he thought it was. He said that it looked like we were approaching land. I asked our navigator to check our position. He did and replied that

UNIDENTIFIED FLYING OBJECT

^{BETHUNE} The weather was excellent. The moon had set but visibility was good. Lt. B. and the plane commander, Lt. K., who was in the copilot's seat, could make out the horizon clearly. Asleep in the aircraft were two extra crews, one a relief for B.'s men, the other on board as passengers. The R5D was at 10,000 feet on a south-

A
PROVOCATIVE
TALE



20 YEARS AGO IN NA NEWS

we were on flight plan and on course.

"The lights were farther away than we thought because it took us eight to ten minutes to get close enough to where the lights had a pattern (our ground speed was over three miles per minute), about 15-20 or 25 miles away. At that time, due to the circular pattern of lights, I got the impression that possibly two ships were tied up together and that lights were strung between them for either transferring cargo from one to the other or that one was in some kind of trouble.

"I asked the navigator to check his ship plot. He replied that there were no ships plotted in this area and that we were not close to the shipping lanes anyway. The radio-man also went on the air to the weather ship, which verified that there were no ships in the area.

"Since it was time for Lt. J.'s crew to relieve us, I had the plane captain awaken them. When Lt. J. and Lt. M. came up forward, I pointed the lights out to them. Their only comment was that it had to be a ship because it was on the water and we were overtaking it fast. By this time, we were five to seven miles away; it was about 30 degrees to our right; and we had to look down at about a 45-degree angle. The lights had a definite circular pattern and were bright white.

"Suddenly, the lights went out. There appeared a yellow halo on the water. It turned to orange, to a fiery red, and then started moving toward us at a fantastic speed, turning to a bluish red around the perimeter. Due to its high speed, its direction of travel and its size, it looked as though we were going to be engulfed. I quickly disengaged the autopilot and stood by to push the nose of the plane over in hopes that we could pass under it because of the angle at which it was ascending. The relief crew was standing behind us; everyone began ducking and a few heads were hit on objects.

"It stopped its movement toward us and began moving along with us about 45 degrees off the bow to the right, about 100 feet or so below us and about 200 to 300 feet in front of us. It was not in a level position; it

was tilted about 25 degrees.

"It stayed in this position for a minute or so. It appeared to be from 200 to 300 feet in diameter, translucent or metallic, shaped like a saucer. A purple-red glow around the perimeter was the same type of glow you get around the commutator of an auto generator when you observe it at night.

"When the object moved away from us, it made no turns, as though it was backing up about 170 degrees from the direction from which it approached us, and was still tilted. It was only a few seconds before it was out of sight. (Speed estimated in excess of 1,500 mph.)

"All of our cameras were within reach, but no one was calm enough to think about taking a picture. Most of us were wondering what it was. Our impression was that this was a controlled craft. It had been either hovering over the water or sitting on it; then it detected us and came up to investigate.

"After Lt. J.'s crew had taken over, I proceeded aft and learned that most of the passengers had observed the same thing. Since I was unable to identify the object, I asked Dr. M., a commander in the Medical Corps, if he had observed the object. He replied that he had and that he did not look further because it was a flying saucer and he did not believe in such things. I immediately returned to the cockpit and informed the crew to keep quiet about what we observed because it might have been our first sighting of a flying saucer (during those years when you mentioned you had such a sighting, you were believed to be crazy). Lt. J. informed me that it was too late because he had called Gander Airfield in Newfoundland to see if the object could be tracked by radar.

"When we landed we were met by intelligence officers. It was obvious that there had been many sightings in the same area. . . . Subsequently, when we arrived in the United States, we had to make a full report and I found out a few months later than Gander radar did track the object in excess of 1,800 mph."

MCAS CHERRY POINT — A favorite ready room conversation for Second Marine Air Wing pilots has been the story of the "flying saucer" which recently outsped an F9F *Panther* jet flying more than 500 mph.

The jet pilot, 1st Lt. Ed Balocco, was on a local night flight from ALF Edenton when alerted by Navy Norfolk tower to watch for a silver object sighted from the ground near the North Carolina-Virginia line.

Over Washington, N.C., the VMF-224 pilot said, "I saw what looked like an airplane with red lights which appeared to be below me. . . . It moved from below me 10,000 feet vertically in a matter of seconds."

Balocco said he poured on the coal and could not close on the object at first, then closed rapidly. He considered it a "big" object, the color of white heat and throwing out a glow. It had what appeared to be two red lights on the lefthand side, flashing and bouncing off the end, inscribing an arc.

As the object began pulling away again, the pilot radioed other planes in the area to help track it. Diving toward the spot where the object disappeared, Balocco thought he saw a flash but was unable to see it again. By then he was joined by Captain Thomas W. Riggs of the same squadron, who sighted an object flying near the coastline but could not identify it.

Similar flashes were reported by a Navy pilot from Norfolk and Gerald Midget of Oriental, N.C. Midget told of the flash being followed by a ground fire but no explosion. Marine helicopters later searched the area and found a small forest fire but no traces of a crash.

The object was first reported by a helicopter at 1747. Ground control intercept radar failed to pick it up but Balocco sighted it about 1800.

Balocco, a veteran of 550 jet hours and 1,000 flying hours, said visibility was so good that from 20,000 feet at Washington he could see the lights at Norfolk and the Cherry Point beacon. He had the object in sight three or four minutes.

Bibliography

The following is a list of publications known to me that discuss our UFO sighting. It is probably not complete. Only items 4, 10, 12 and 13 were based on interviews with me. Almost all of this material contains major errors of fact.

1. *Flying Saucers -- Top Secret*, by Major Donald Keyhoe, 1960, Chapter 1, pages 9-26. Admiral Fahrney demands congressional hearings, page 26, Keyhoe is interviewed on CBS TV, begins to say he has an important announcement, and CBS turns off his microphone! The entire Chapter 1 is attached as an appendix.
2. *Confidential NICAP Report To Congress*, by Major Donald Keyhoe, June 21, 1960, page 56.
3. *Aliens From Space*, 1973, by Major Donald Keyhoe, Chapter 6, pages 92-105. Keyhoe says NICAP intended to use our "startling case" and crew testimony for congressional hearings. Page 103, Admiral Hillenkoetter's letter to Congress. The entire Chapter 6 is attached as an appendix.
4. NICAP Newsletters for September and October 1970. These newsletters are attached as an appendix.
5. June 1973 issue of *Naval Aviation News*, pages 18-19, article titled "Unidentified Flying Object," a special issue that included a discussion of the famous "lost patrol" Flight 19 lost in the "Bermuda Triangle." This article is attached as an appendix.
6. *UFOs Explained*, by Philip Klass, 1974, pages 61 through 73.
7. Time-Life book series "Mysteries of the Unknown," volume titled *The UFO Phenomenon*, 1983, pages 48-49.
8. *Above Top Secret -- The Worldwide UFO Coverup*, by Timothy Good, 1989, pages 268 and 486. This book contains an excellent account of Major Keyhoe's work, the infiltration and destruction of NICAP by the CIA, and other U.S. Government activities designed to obscure the UFO phenomenon. The 1951 North Atlantic encounter should be seen in this context. Page 339, discussion of CIA order to debunk UFO reports and discredit witnesses.
9. *UFO Crash Secrets*, by James W. Moseley, 1991, page VI.

10. *UFOs: The Secret Evidence*, a video film by Michael Hesemann, produced by CLIP Film, Munich and 2000 Film Production, Dusseldorf, 1992. This video won six EBE awards at the International UFO Congress and Film Festival, and was the best selling UFO video for four years running from 1994 through 1997.

11. *Beyond Top Secret*, by Timothy Good, 1993.

12. *Geheimsache UFO*, by Michael Hesemann, 1994, pages 59-65, 223, 251-254. This includes the color painting I did in 1970. It also has copies of our report on file in the National Archives. This is a good account of our case, but only available in German.

13. *UFOs The Secret History*, by Michael Hesemann, 1998, Chapter 5, pages 57-64. My 1970 painting of the UFO is on the front cover and on page 234.

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Appendix